

Linux Foundation forms new tooling project to improve open source compliance

The Linux Foundation, the non-profit organisation enabling mass innovation through open source, has announced the formation of the new Automated Compliance Tooling (ACT) project.

While using open source code, it is necessary to comply with the terms of that code's licence, which can sometimes be challenging for users and organisations to manage. The Linux Foundation says the goal of ACT is to consolidate investments in open source compliance tooling, which will help organisations manage compliance obligations, and increase their interoperability and usability.

In addition to two existing Linux Foundation projects that will become part of the new project, two more projects will be added as part of the initiative.

FOSSology, the open source licence compliance software system and toolkit



that allows users to run licence, copyright and export control scans from the command line is an existing Linux Foundation project that will move under ACT.

QMSTR, also known by the name Quartermaster, creates an integrated open

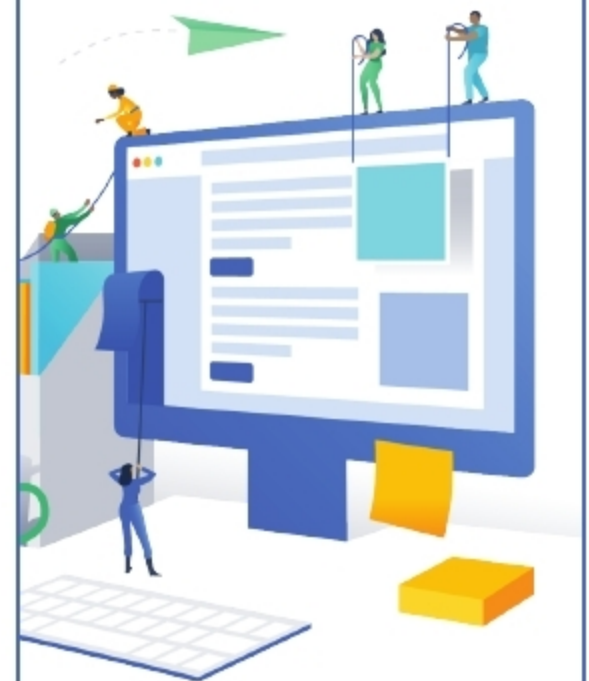
source toolchain that implements industry best practices of licence compliance management. It integrates into the build systems to learn about the software products, their sources and dependencies. Developers can run QMSTR locally to verify outcomes, review problems and produce compliance reports. The project is being contributed to ACT by Endocode.

Software Package Data Exchange (SPDX) is an open standard for communicating software bill of materials information including components, licences, copyrights and security references. The main SPDX specification will remain separate from, yet complementary to, ACT while the SPDX tools that meet the specs and help users and producers of SPDX documents will become part of ACT. It is an existing Linux Foundation project.

Created by VMware, *Tern* is an inspection tool to find the meta data of the packages installed in a container image. It provides a deeper understanding of a container's bill of materials so that better decisions can be made about container based infrastructure, integration and deployment strategies. VMware is contributing the project to ACT to help developers meet open source compliance requirements for containers.

The new projects will be complementary to the existing Linux Foundation compliance projects such as OpenChain and Open Compliance Program. OpenChain identifies key recommended processes to make open source licence compliance simpler and more consistent. The Open Compliance Program educates and helps developers and companies understand their licence requirements and how to build efficient, frictionless and often automated processes to support compliance.

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